

Passenger De-escalation & Reassurance Procedure

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Purpose & scope

This procedure applies to all cabin crew on Skybridge Airways flights when a passenger shows signs of anxiety, agitation, or non-compliance during boarding, taxi, turbulence, or in-flight service. Goal: restore calm without disturbing the cabin or delaying the flight.

Key terms

Lead FA: Senior cabin crew member responsible for the cabin zone.

23B protocol: Hushed-voice reassurance at the passenger's seat; never use PA voice at an individual seat.

Distress signal: White-knuckle grip, repeated seatbelt checks, loud questions to neighbors, or refusal to stow items.

Standard procedure

1. Approach the passenger at their seat — do not block the aisle for more than 30 seconds.
2. Introduce yourself by name and role. Make eye contact at their level (bend if needed).
3. Acknowledge their concern in one sentence before offering facts.
4. Lower your voice to a conversational volume. Match their pace; do not rush.
5. Offer one concrete action (seatbelt, water, blanket, headset) — not a list of options.
6. If turbulence is active, confirm they are seated with seatbelt fastened before moving on.
7. Log the interaction in the cabin report under "Passenger assistance" when time permits.

Approved phrases

"I'm [Name], one of the crew on today's flight. I can see this is unsettling — I'm right here with you."

"We're through the roughest part. Could you buckle up for me? Nice and easy."

"The flight deck has everything under control. Would a glass of water help while we wait?"

"I understand you'd like to move seats. Let me check what's open once the seatbelt sign is off."

Scenarios

Scenario A — Turbulence, seat 23B: A guest grips the armrest during moderate chop. Neighbors are quiet. Lead FA uses 23B protocol: kneel at eye level, whisper reassurance, confirm seatbelt, offer water. Meter goal: passenger nods and loosens grip within 2 exchanges.

Scenario B — Boarding delay: Passenger at 12A demands to know why the door is still open. Associate explains delay in plain language, offers estimated departure update from the flight deck if available, does not speculate on mechanical issues.

Scenario C — Non-compliant bag: Guest refuses to check an oversized carry-on. Crew member cites policy calmly, offers tag-and-gate-check option, escalates to Lead FA only if guest raises voice or blocks boarding.

Escalation matrix

Situation	Action
Verbal abuse toward crew	Lead FA + purser; document; captain informed if safety threat
Physical threat	Secure cabin; captain authority; law enforcement on arrival if needed
Medical distress	Request medic on board / doctor page; first-aid kit per FA-001
Intoxicated passenger	Cut off service; seat assigned; purser documents

Do / Don't

Do: Use the passenger's name if on the manifest; speak slowly; validate feelings before facts.

Don't: Use PA-announcement voice at a single seat; argue policy in front of other passengers; promise arrival times you cannot confirm.